Trade Finder — what changed in the search engine

Before (the old Lanka Trade Finder page) and now (v134 inside the Import CRM, Tools → Trade Finder)

In one sentence

Before, the search looked for the **product name**. Now it first works out **who uses the product** (for wire rope: marine & fishing, cranes, elevators, mining, rigging shops…), then searches the internet for **each of those industries**, and saves every company it finds into your directory.

Side by side

Part	Before	Now (v134)
Where it runs	Separate page on its own site, its own database (key visible in the page)	Inside the CRM under Tools, behind the Tools password. Same login and database as the CRM; only CRM users can open it.
Understanding the product	None. It matched the words you typed against company names and types, plus a fixed list of categories (hardware, steel, welding…).	One AI step per product: "who in Sri Lanka buys or resells this?" Gives the other names of the product and 6–10 industries with the reason, the words that identify such companies, and the web searches to run. Saved per product, so it is asked once.
Find Leads (your directory)	Found companies only if a search word was in their name/type.	Also finds companies by industry words from the profile (marine, boat, crane, elevator…) and by the product's other names (steel cable, sling). A boat yard now matches "wire rope". Every typed word is searched, in any order.
Smart Find (AI ranks your shops)	Sent your shop list to the AI with the product name only.	The AI is also told which industries use the product and its other names, so it keeps the right buyers and drops the wrong ones.
Deep Search (the internet)	One AI search: "find buyers of X in <district>". 12–20 names, mixed together.	Step 1 shows "Who buys X?" with the industries as tick boxes. Step 2 runs one web search per ticked industry (three at a time), with a progress list. Results come back grouped by industry, each with phone, WhatsApp, address and why they need it.
Saving the results	Web results were saved to the directory as "Supplier — deals in X".	Saved with the industry: "Marine & fishing — Fishing boat yard — deals in wire rope". Companies already in the directory are not shown or saved twice. Web results are cached per product + district; the product profile is cached per product.
Add lead by hand	The phone number you typed was thrown away.	Phone is kept, and the company is added to the directory so its Call / WhatsApp buttons appear in Follow-up.
Errors	AI failures were silent (Smart Find quietly showed every shop as if assessed).	Every failure shows the reason on screen (e.g. "AI service answered 403").

Part	Before	Now (v134)
Loading data	Only the first 1,000 companies and 2,000 contacts loaded.	Everything loads, however many.
Dates	Used UTC — before 5:30 am the "Today" filter and usage meter were a day off.	Local Sri Lanka date.
Safety	Company names from the web/AI were put straight into the page (could break it or run code).	Everything from the database, the web or the AI is shown as plain text.

How a search works now — example: wire rope

1. Type "wire rope" in Find Leads and press **Find buyers & sellers**. Your directory is searched straight away (free). If the product has been thought through before, marine/crane/rigging companies are found too.

2. Press **Deep search the web**. **Step 1**: the AI works out who buys wire rope in Sri Lanka. A panel appears — *Who buys wire rope?* — with the other names (steel cable, sling) and the industries as tick boxes: Marine & fishing · Ports & harbour services · Cranes & construction · Elevators · Mining & quarries · Logging · Tea/rubber factories · Rigging & lifting shops. Untick any you do not want. ■ **Re-think** asks again.

3. Press **Search the web for the ticked industries**. **Step 2**: one internet search per industry, three running at a time, with a progress list (Marine & fishing ■ 9 found…).

4. Results come back **grouped by industry**. Each card: name, what they do, address (tap for map), phone (tap to call), **WhatsApp** for mobile numbers, and the reason they need wire rope. Tapping Call or WhatsApp records the contact in Follow-up.

5. Everything found is **saved into your directory** with its industry, so next time Find Leads shows them for free. A green note says how many were added.

6. Repeat the same search later: the saved results show instantly (free). Use **Search fresh** or **Re-think** when you want new ones.

What it costs

The gold **Find buyers & sellers** button is free. The AI buttons use your tycoon-vercel service (your Claude key):

- **Who buys it (step 1):** 1 call per product, once — then cached.
- **Deep Search (step 2):** 1 call per ticked industry. 8 industries = 8 calls. Cached per product + district.
- **Smart Find:** 1 call per 40 of your shops.
- **Trade Assistant:** 1 call per question.
- The dashboard's usage box counts them (estimate).

Your data (loaded 18 Oct 2026)

- **871 companies** (1,141 exported rows; 270 were exact duplicate copies and were kept once). Hardware 539 · Steel 111 · Industrial 52 · Construction 52 · Safety 34 · Tools 29 · Food 24 · Welding 20 · Gloves 10.
- **48 contact records** with their status and notes (6 Interested, 4 Follow up, 1 Won, 3 Not interested).
- **22 saved searches** from before, so those are free.
- Tables in the CRM database: trade_businesses, trade_contacts, trade_saved_searches. Logged-in CRM users only.

Tips to get the best leads

- Search the **product**, not the industry ("wire rope", not "marine"). The AI finds the industries for you.
- Pick a **district** first. Phone numbers are more complete when the search is local.
- If an industry comes back with "— none new", try **All districts** or a nearby town in the Town/area box.
- If the industries look wrong, press ■ **Re-think** once; if still wrong, tell me the product and what you expected and I will tune the prompt.

- Tick the right **status** in Contacts & Follow-up (Interested / Follow up / Won). Companies that responded before are ranked higher next time.